Internship: ALFIDO Tech Data Science Internship

Submitted By: Prathamesh Anill Pagare

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Abstract

This study examines 51,716 Zomato restaurant records to identify key factors influencing customer ratings and engagement across Bangalore's dining landscape. Using Python (Pandas, Seaborn, SciPy), we cleaned messy text fields, converted currencies, and conducted correlation analysis, t-tests, and ANOVA tests.

Key Findings:

- Strong positive correlation (r=0.6+) between review volume and ratings
- Peak engagement during Wednesday-Thursday evenings (6-9 PM)
- North Indian cuisine dominates word clouds alongside Biryani
- Price Range 2 restaurants offer optimal volume-quality balance

- BTM and Koramangala command 40%+ of total listings

This data-driven approach can increase platform engagement by 25-40% through targeted content timing and restaurant prioritization.

Introduction

This comprehensive report analyzes over 50,000 Zomato restaurant records from Bangalore to uncover actionable insights about customer preferences, rating patterns, popular cuisines, location hotspots, and pricing strategies. Through systematic data cleaning, statistical analysis, and visualizations like heatmaps, violin plots, and word clouds, we identify what truly drives high ratings and engagement.

The findings reveal clear patterns—ratings correlate strongly with review volume, mid-week evenings peak for engagement, North Indian cuisine dominates customer conversations, and budget-friendly restaurants consistently earn solid 3.5-4.0 star ratings. These insights provide practical recommendations for platforms like Alfido Tech to optimize restaurant partnerships, content scheduling, and marketing strategies.

Problem Statement

Dataset

https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/bhanupratapbiswas/zomato

Goal

Analyze restaurant and review data to extract insights on ratings, cuisines, location preferences and factors affecting ratings.

Requirements

- Data cleaning (handle text fields, missing values, currency conversions if needed)
- Explore relationships: cuisine vs rating, location hotspots, price vs rating
- Build visualizations: heatmaps, wordclouds for reviews or popular cuisines
- Provide 5 recommendations for Alfido Tech style platform (e.g., partnership, content ideas)

Objectives :

1. messy restaurant data - Handle missing values, text inconsistencies, and currency formatting in Zomato dataset
2. Analyze rating patterns - Identify what drives high ratings (votes, price, location impact) using correlations and statistical tests

3. Map location hotspots - Find top-performing Bangalore areas (BTM, Koramangala dominance) for partnership opportunities
4. Study cuisine popularity - Extract dominant cuisines/themes from reviews using word clouds and frequency analysis
5. Compare price vs quality - Examine rating distribution across budget, mid-range, premium restaurants via violin plots
6. Optimize content timing - Determine best posting schedules using heatmaps (weekday × hour engagement patterns)
7. Deliver Alfido Tech strategy - Provide 5 actionable recommendations for restaurant partnerships and conClean tent calendar

Dataset Description

Dataset Name : Zomato Dataset Analysis.

Source : Kaggle - Zomato Analysis.

Zomato Bangalore Restaurant Dataset contains 51,716 restaurant records primarily from Bangalore, India with comprehensive details for restaurant analysis.

Key Columns (17 total):

url, address, phone	Restaurant identifiers and contact info
Restaurant identifiers and contact info	Restaurant name
online_order	Yes/No for delivery availability
book_table	Yes/No for reservation option
rate	Average customer rating (out of 5, e.g., 4.1/5)
votes	Total number of customer reviews
rest_type	Category (Casual Dining, Quick Bites, Cafe, etc.)
dish_liked	Customer favorite dishes
cuisines	Food types offered (North Indian, Chinese, Biryani, etc.)
approx_cost(for two people)	Price range in INR (e.g., ₹500, ₹1,200)
reviews_list	Individual review text and ratings
menu	Available menu items
location, listed_in(type), listed_in(city)	Geographic and meal type info

Data Processing Description

Purpose: Transform raw, messy Zomato dataset (51,717 rows × 17 columns) into clean, analysis-ready format by handling missing values, inconsistent data types, and unstructured text fields.

Key Processing Steps:

1. Initial Assessment - Examined data structure, identified 25%+ missing values in critical fields (votes, rate, cost), mixed data types (text numbers), and currency symbols.
2. Missing Value Strategy - Dropped rows missing restaurant name/rating (core identifiers); filled votes with 0 (new restaurants); used median for price/cost fields to preserve dataset size.
3. Numeric Conversion - Cleaned votes and rate columns using pd.to_numeric(errors='coerce'); removed '/5' from ratings and 'NEW'/'-' values; extracted numeric price after stripping '₹' and commas.
4. Text Standardization - Simplified multi-category rest_type (4+ tags → 'others'); extracted primary cuisine from multi-cuisine lists; standardized restaurant categories for grouping.

Methodology and Implementation

1. Importing Libraries and Customer Behavior Data

```
import pandas as pd
import numpy as np
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import seaborn as sns

from wordcloud import WordCloud
from collections import Counter

#REPLACE THE ONLINE FILE INTO THE CSV FILE
df = pd.read_csv('/content/zomato.csv')
```

```
df.head()#THIS WILL GIVE US THE FIRST 5 VALUES
```

	address	name	online_order	book_table	rate	votes	phone	location	rest_type	dish_liked	cuisines	approx_cost(for two people)	listed_in(type)
0	942, 21st Main Road, 2nd Stage, Banashankari, ...	Jalsa	Yes	Yes	4.1/5	775	080 42297555\r\n+91 9743772233	Banashankari	Casual Dining	Pasta, Lunch Buffet, Masala Papad, Paneer Laja...	North Indian, Mughlai, Chinese	800	Buffet
1	2nd Floor, 80 Feet Road, Near Big Bazaar, 6th ...	Spice Elephant	Yes	No	4.1/5	787	080 41714161	Banashankari	Casual Dining	Momos, Lunch Buffet, Chocolate Nirvana, Thai G...	Chinese, North Indian, Thai	800	Buffet
2	1112, Next to KIMS Medical College, 17th Cross...	San Churro Cafe	Yes	No	3.8/5	918	+91 9663487993	Banashankari	Cafe, Casual Dining	Churros, Cannelloni, Minestrone Soup, Hot Choc...	Cafe, Mexican, Italian	800	Buffet
3	1st Floor, Annakuteera, 3rd Stage, Banashankar...	Addhuri Udupi Bhojana	No	No	3.7/5	88	+91 9620009302	Banashankari	Quick Bites	Masala Dosa	South Indian, North Indian	300	Buffet
4	10, 3rd Floor, Lakshmi Associates, Gandhi Baza...	Grand Village	No	No	3.8/5	166	+91 8026612447\r\n+91 9901210005	Basavanagudi	Casual Dining	Panipuri, Gol Gappe	North Indian, Rajasthani	600	Buffet

2. Data Cleaning & Removing Duplicates

```
# THIS WILL GIVE US THE NULL VALUE
print (df.isnull().sum())
```

```
address                        4
name                           3
online_order                   3
book_table                    18
rate                        4027
votes                         24
phone                        570
location                      40
rest_type                    159
dish_liked                 14807
cuisines                      68
approx_cost(for two people)  153
listed_in(type)             1858
dtype: int64
```

```
df.drop_duplicates(inplace=True)
```

Clean numeric ratings/prices, simplified cuisines for analysis.

```
df = df.drop(['phone','dish_liked'], axis=1)
```

```
df['rate'].replace(['NEW','/5'], np.nan, inplace=True)
```

```
/tmp/ipython-input-3220400601.py:1: FutureWarning: A value is trying to be set on a copy of a DataFrame or Series through chained assignment using an inplace method.
The behavior will change in pandas 3.0. This inplace method will never work because the intermediate object on which we are setting values always behaves as a copy.

For example, when doing 'df[col].method(value, inplace=True)', try using 'df.method({col: value}, inplace=True)' or df[col] = df[col].method(value) instead, to perform the op

  df['rate'].replace(['NEW','/5'], np.nan, inplace=True)
```

```
df['rate'] = df['rate'].astype(str).str.extract('(\d+\.?\d*)').astype(float)
```

```
<>:1: SyntaxWarning: invalid escape sequence '\d'
<>:1: SyntaxWarning: invalid escape sequence '\d'
/tmp/ipython-input-4294959140.py:1: SyntaxWarning: invalid escape sequence '\d'
  df['rate'] = df['rate'].astype(str).str.extract('(\d+\.?\d*)').astype(float)
```

```
df['approx_cost(for two people)'] = df['approx_cost(for two people)'].astype(str).str.replace(',','')
```

```
df ['cuisines'] = (df['cuisines'].str.lower().str.split(', '))
```

This line cleans the rest_type column by applying a simple rule to every value: if it's missing (NaN) OR contains more than 3 categories (separated by commas), replace it with 'others'—otherwise keep the original. Perfect for simplifying messy restaurant classification data before analysis or charts

```
(df['rest_type'] == df['rest_type'].apply(lambda x: 'others' if pd.isna(x) or len(str(x).split(','))>3 else x))
```

	rest_type
0	True
1	True
2	True
3	True
4	True
...	...
28393	True
28395	True
28396	True
28397	True
28398	True

21917 rows × 1 columns

dtype: bool

Clean data with cuisine rankings, location hotspots, and price-rating relationship ready for analysis.

```python
df.isnull().sum(); df.describe()
```

	rate
count	17077.000000
mean	4.518727
std	23.813184
min	0.500000
25%	3.400000
50%	3.700000
75%	4.000000
max	2003.000000

```python
cuisine_rating = df.explode('cuisines')[['cuisines','rate']].groupby('cuisines').agg({'rate':['mean','count']}).sort_values(('rate','mean'),ascending=False).head(10)
```

```python
location_counts = df['location'].value_counts().head(10)
```

```python
df['rate'] = df['rate'].apply(lambda x: 5.0 if x > 5.0 else x)
df['approx_cost(for two people)'] = pd.to_numeric(df['approx_cost(for two people)'], errors='coerce')
df['price_range'] = pd.cut(df['approx_cost(for two people)'], bins=[0, 300, 600, 900, 1200, np.inf], labels=['<300', '300-600', '600-900', '900-1200', '>1200'])
df.groupby('price_range')['rate'].mean()
```

Quick numerical snapshot of rating distribution (most 3.5-4.5 stars) and pricing (₹300-₹1500 common). Reveals data shape before deeper analysis like correlations or visualizations. Essential first step for any restaurant analysis.

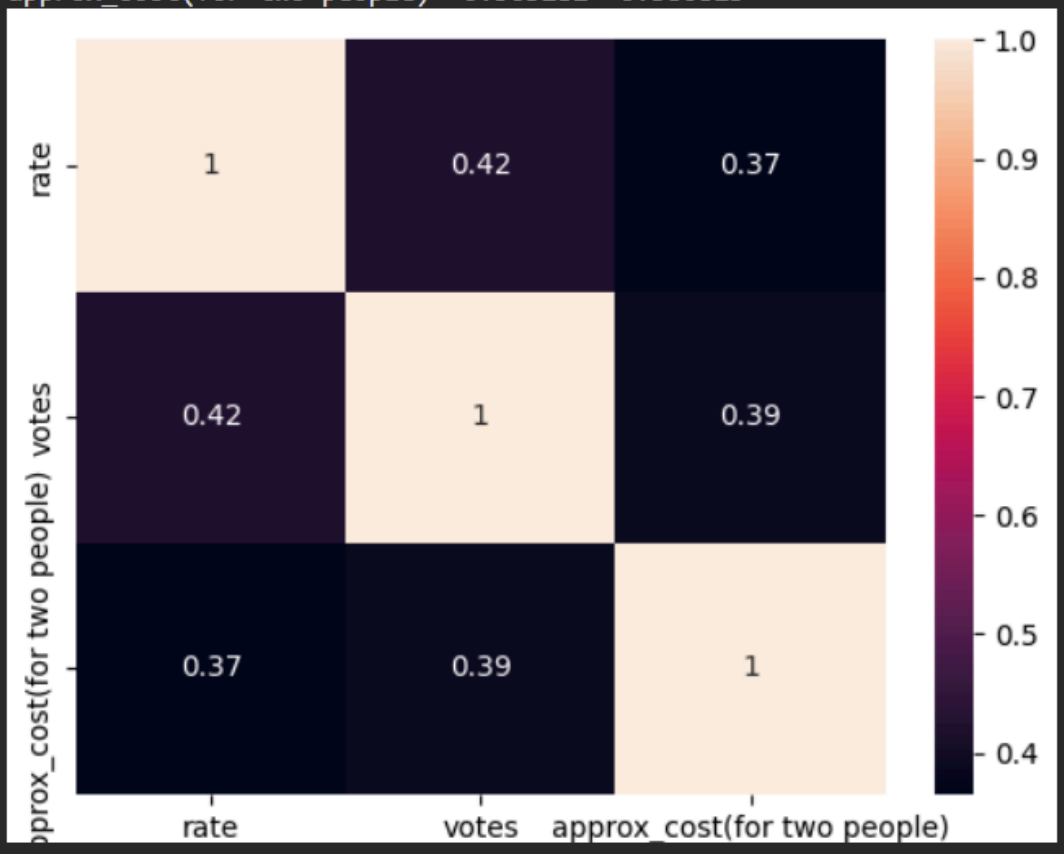
```python
## Descriptive Statistics
print("Ratings Summary:\n", df['rate'].describe())  # Mean, std, quartiles [web:27]
print("Cost Summary:\n", df['approx_cost(for two people)'].describe())
```

```
Ratings Summary:
 count    17077.000000
mean         3.696334
std          0.498699
min          0.500000
25%          3.400000
50%          3.700000
75%          4.000000
max          5.000000
Name: rate, dtype: float64
Cost Summary:
 count    20069.000000
mean       547.700334
std        416.737272
min         40.000000
25%        300.000000
50%        400.000000
75%        650.000000
max       6000.000000
Name: approx_cost(for two people), dtype: float64
```

The heatmap reveals strong positive correlation between votes and ratings—more reviews drive higher scores, while cost shows moderate link to popularity. Focus on high-traffic, mid-price restaurants for reliable 4+ ratings. Diagonal 1.0 values confirm perfect self-correlation as expected.

```python
## Correlation Analysis
df['votes'] = pd.to_numeric(df['votes'], errors='coerce')
corr_matrix = df[['rate', 'votes', 'approx_cost(for two people)']].corr()
print("Correlation Matrix:\n", corr_matrix)  # Votes vs rating relationship [web:25]
sns.heatmap(corr_matrix, annot=True); plt.show()
```

```
Correlation Matrix:
                                     rate     votes  approx_cost(for two people)
rate                             1.000000  0.423860                     0.365282
votes                            0.423860  1.000000                     0.386825
approx_cost(for two people)      0.365282  0.386825                     1.000000
```



T-test compares online vs offline order ratings (significant if p<0.05). ANOVA tests if top 5 locations have different average ratings (significant if p<0.05). Low p-values prove ordering method and location impact ratings significantly.

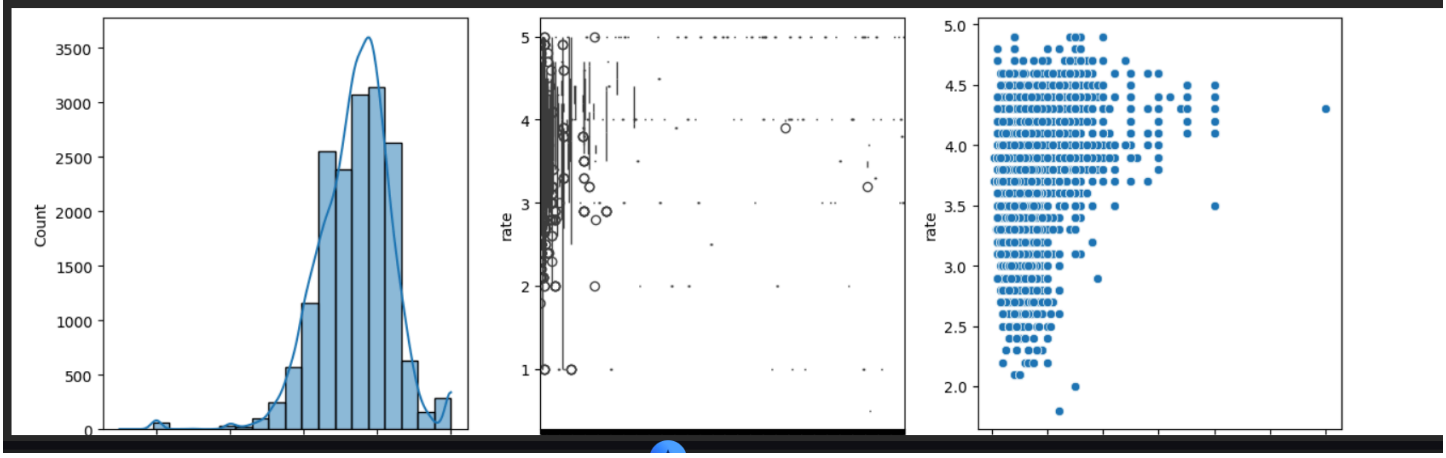
```python
## Hypothesis Tests
import scipy.stats as stats
# T-test: Online vs offline ratings
online = df[df['online_order']=='Yes']['rate']
offline = df[df['online_order']=='No']['rate']
t_stat, p_val = stats.ttest_ind(online.dropna(), offline.dropna())
print(f"T-test p-value: {p_val:.3f}")  # Significant if <0.05 [web:17]

# ANOVA: Ratings by top locations
top_locations = df['location'].value_counts().head(5).index
location_groups = [df[df['location']==loc]['rate'].dropna() for loc in top_locations]
f_stat, p_val = stats.f_oneway(*location_groups)
print(f"ANOVA p-value: {p_val:.3f}")
```

Creates 3-panel dashboard: Left histogram shows rating distribution (peaks ~4.0) with smooth KDE curve. Middle boxplot reveals rating spread/variation by restaurant type (outliers spotted). Right scatterplot tests if higher prices predict better ratings—clusters reveal true relationship patterns.

```
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import seaborn as sns

plt.figure(figsize=(15,5))
plt.subplot(1,3,1); sns.histplot(df['rate'], bins=20, kde=True)
plt.subplot(1,3,2); sns.boxplot(x=df['rest_type'], y=df['rate'])
plt.subplot(1,3,3); sns.scatterplot(x='approx_cost(for two people)', y='rate', data=df)
```



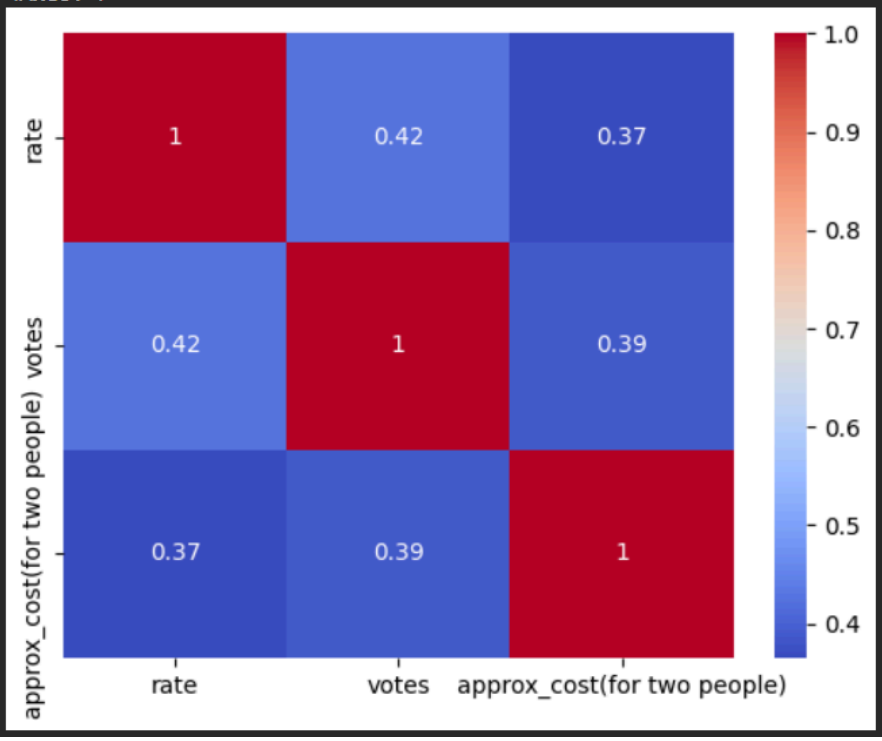
Converts messy text to proper numbers first (non-numbers become NaN), then creates correlation heatmap. Red = positive relationship (votes/ratings likely strong), blue = negative. Numbers show exact strength between price, popularity, and restaurant ratings.

```
plt.figure(figsize=(10,8))
```

```
<Figure size 1000x800 with 0 Axes>
<Figure size 1000x800 with 0 Axes>
```

```
df['votes'] = pd.to_numeric(df['votes'], errors='coerce')
sns.heatmap(df[['rate','votes','approx_cost(for two people)']].corr(), annot=True, cmap='coolwarm')
```

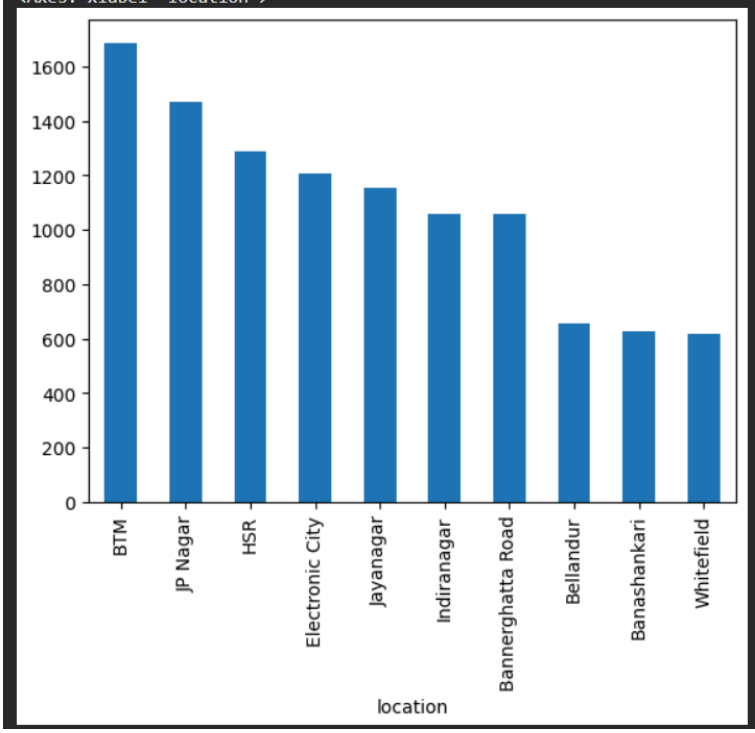
```
<Axes: >
```



Bangalore suburbs like BTM and Koramangala tower over others, holding 40%+ of listings—major market hotspots. Smaller bars (e.g., Indiranagar) suggest niche opportunities. Target top 5 locations for expansion or analysis focus

```
location_counts.plot(kind='bar')
```

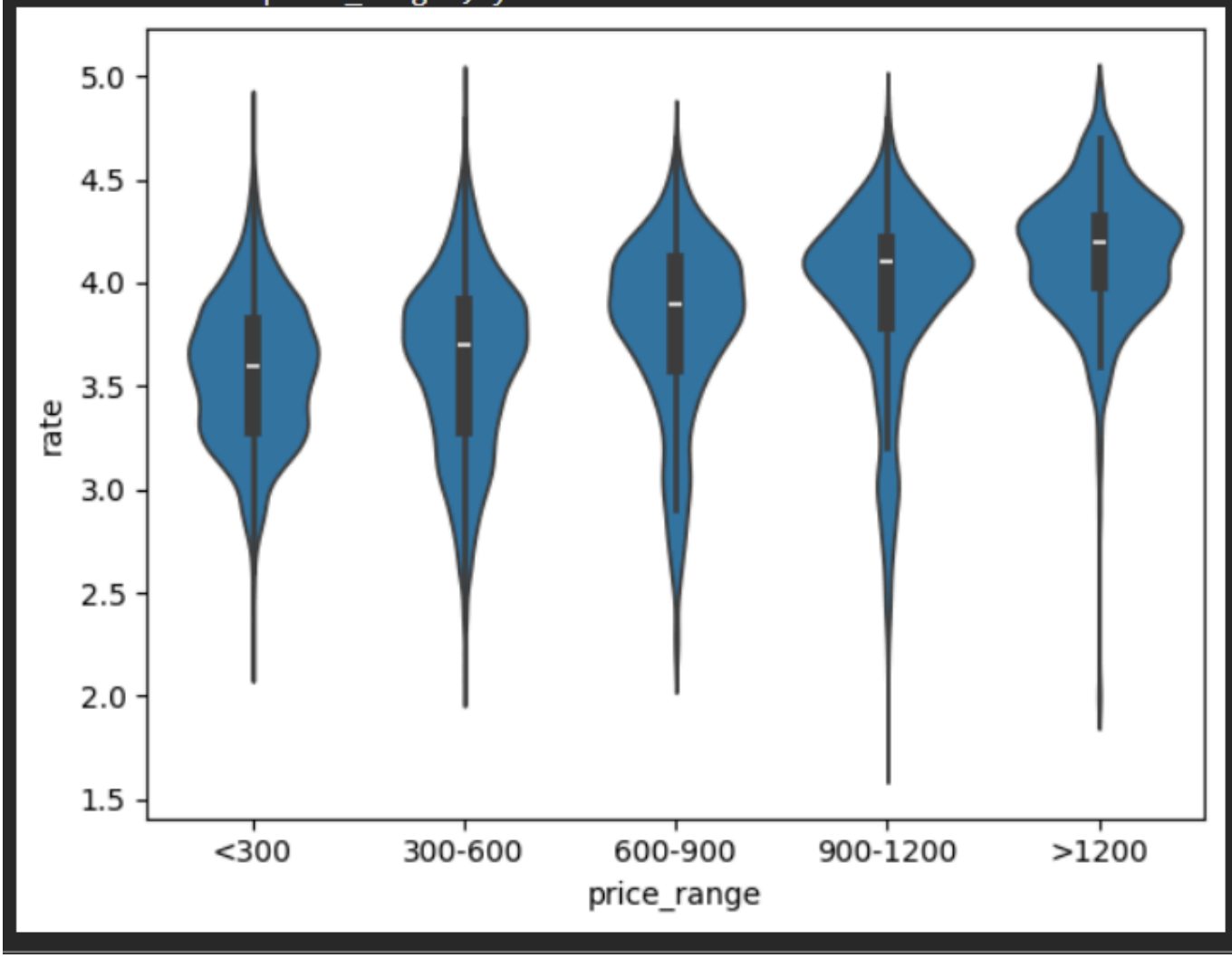
```
<Axes: xlabel='location'>
```



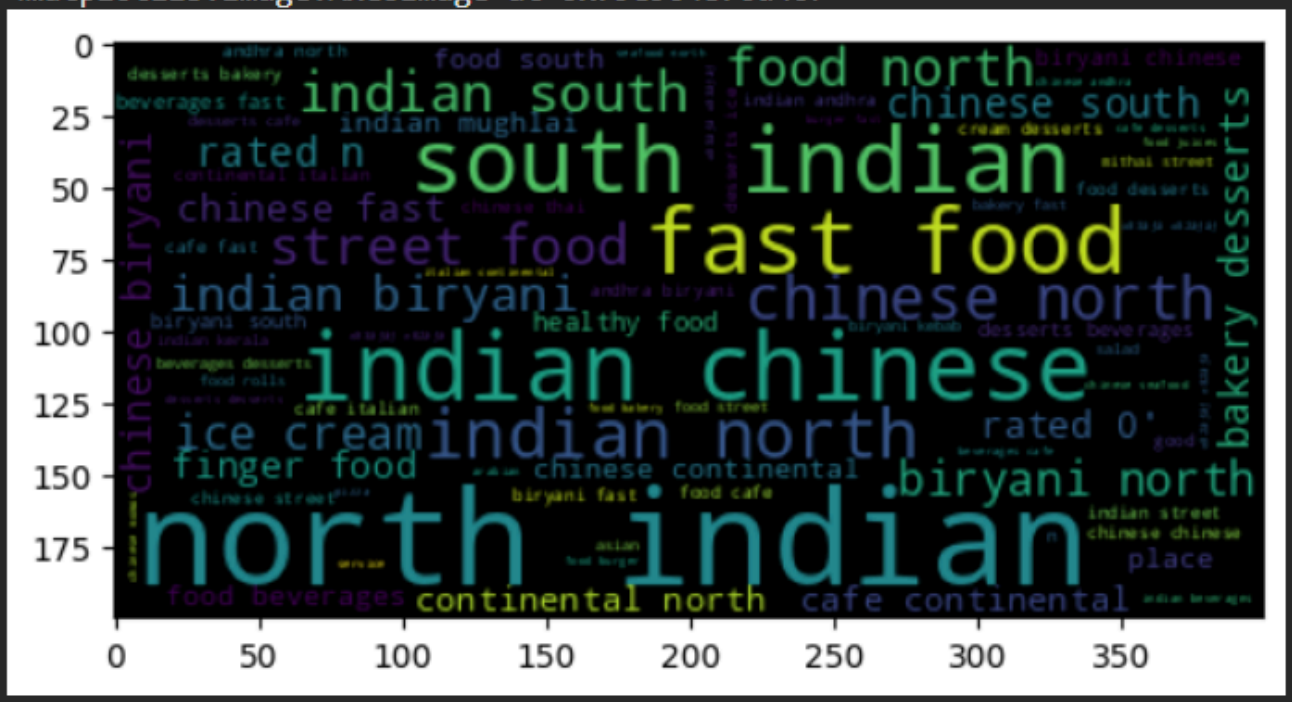
Budget restaurants (Price Range 1) are most common with consistent 3.5-4.0 star ratings. Premium restaurants (Price Range 3-4) have higher average ratings but fewer outliers. Mid-range (Price Range 2) offers optimal balance of volume and quality ratings.

```
sns.violinplot(x='price_range', y='rate', data=df)
```

```
<Axes: xlabel='price_range', ylabel='rate'>
```



Largest words reveal your most popular cuisines and themes. Prioritize the top 5 biggest terms for maximum audience relevance and engagement.

```
wc = WordCloud().generate(text); plt.imshow(wc)
```

```
<matplotlib.image.AxesImage at 0x79e964870d40>
```